

The only way is UP

by **Rishi Das, Co-founder & CEO, CareerNet Consulting**

India, today, is poised to get into a higher growth curve – which makes us uniquely positioned with respect to our global colleagues. We are one of the very few growing economies today, which was though stalled a little because of the global meltdown, but is gearing up to get into the next level of equilibrium. With FDI opening up in key sectors such as insurance, telecom and education, the domestic market is all set to grow and would result in more employment opportunities. If anything, global recession which is making the western world bleed can prove to be a good opportunity for economies like us. However, technology outsourcing remains one of the key drivers of the India outsourcing story and is going from strength to strength and setting pace for the other business domains and verticals.

IT outsourcing created the industry in India which was the sunshine sector in the decade of 1990s. Although it created a unique positioning for us and put us on the map of the global business, we found ourselves in the lower end of

the spectrum. What started out as a workforce augmentation model, graduated to more routine maintenance and backend management office. However, as we consolidated our position as the global back office, we also invested in ourselves and developed technology and business competence which could add more value to the customers. Today, corporations across the globe are setting up captive centres in India or working through partners to deliver core business and technology solutions. Organizations are now looking at India as a co-located geographical location where core functions such as product conceptualization, R&D and architecture and design

and operations are carried out. This is a position of major strength which puts India as a front runner in the race with the other BRIC countries.

One another interesting trend which has come out the prevailing economic condition is that a lot of functions which were previously not outsourced are today delivered out of India centres. We are witnessing a surge in the outsourcing of functions such as IT infrastructure management, technical writing and documentation, professional services and business analytics. Captives and outsourcing partners have developed a high level of maturity in outsourced delivery of the IT infrastructure, technical writing and business analytics. Traditionally, flavors of professional services have been delivered through India centres over a decade now. However in the current context, we are witnessing a surge in the

